

Birdham Carpentry & Building

A name, a mark drawn from the founder's own sketch, a website, and the quoting, invoicing and payments system that runs the firm behind it.

CLIENT

Birdham Carpentry & Building

SECTOR

Building and joinery

YEAR

2026

LIVE

birdhamcarpentry.co.uk ↗

SCOPE

Naming, Brand identity, Website design, Development, Estimating engine, Operations backend

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01 The commission

Birdham Carpentry & Building is a new firm working across Chichester and the South Downs on listed and period building restoration, fine joinery, bespoke kitchens and sympathetic building work. The commission covered everything a trade business needs on the day it opens: a name, a mark, a website, and the system behind the website that runs quotes, jobs and invoices.

Trade websites divide into two kinds. There is the phone number on a template, and there is the lead portal that sells the same enquiry to three other builders. In a catchment full of listed and period property, nobody was presenting craft properly and nobody was quoting online. The brief was to look like the most careful firm in the county from the first day of trading, and to have the operational machinery to back that up.

The whole thing was built in a single day. The commit history runs from 11:25 to 22:53 on 22 July 2026, fifty-seven commits, and it covers the naming, the mark, the website, the estimating engine, the quote and invoice PDFs, the payments and the operations backend. That is not a claim about heroics. It is a claim about what a small studio can do when the decisions are made in the right order and there is nobody to hand work between.

11:25

Initial build, as Halnaker Construction

Brand, site and quote system, under the first name

11:43

The Mill Mark refined

Sails-forward windmill, plus a seal variant and favicon

12:11

Operations connected to Supabase

The same commit moved the reading face from Libre Caslon Text to Spectral

13:04

Repositioned to lead with restoration

Oak receded from the front of the offer, which is what made the name a problem

13:16

Renamed to Birdham Carpentry & Building

The windmill went with the name. The seabird replaced it

14:17

Quote and invoice PDFs branded

The new mark carried into the documents

17:11

The gull identity wired through

Site and PDF generators on one mark

17:52

Lockup balanced

The mark sized against the nav and the wordmark lines aligned on both edges

22:53

Invoices rendered from the real page

The last commit of the day, matching the quote pipeline

COMMITTS

ELAPSED

NAMES

MARKS

57

11h 28m

2

2

Taken from the project's commit history, which is why the times are to the minute. Only the commits that changed a decision are listed.

02 The name

The firm was not called Birdham first. It opened as Halnaker Construction, named after the village and its windmill on the Downs north of Chichester, and it traded under a complete identity: a latticed windmill mark, a Spectral wordmark, and the sub-line Oak Carpentry & Building. The site, the quote flow and the operations backend were all built under that name.

Two things were wrong with it, and they were connected. The sub-line led with oak, which narrowed the firm to one material at exactly the moment the offer was being widened to restoration and general building. And Halnaker sits inland, on the wrong side of the catchment from the harbour villages where much of the work is.

The rename fixed both. Birdham is a village on Chichester Harbour whose name derives from the Old English for settlement of the birds, so it gave the firm a name rooted in the right part of the catchment and, directly, its mark. A name that produces its own symbol without a second creative step is worth more than a cleverer one that does not.



Halnaker Construction, the replaced lockup

The windmill mark with the wordmark in Spectral and Oak Carpentry & Building beneath

SUPERSEDED NAME

OAK-LED

WINDMILL MARK



The Mill Mark

Halnaker Windmill with latticed common sails, drawn as a single-colour silhouette

SUPERSEDED

The windmill was a good mark and it went anyway. It is worth being clear why, because it is the kind of decision that gets described as taste and is usually not. The gull that replaced it holds the same qualities, a single flat silhouette that embroiders and reduces cleanly, while belonging to the harbour rather than to a hill eight miles inland. When the name stopped being defensible the mark went with it, because a mark that illustrates the wrong name is a mark with a job it cannot do.

03 The mark

The mark is a gull in flight, vectorised from the founder's own drawing and then refined until the wings balanced, the larger wing carried a proper curve, the body was slimmed and the beak came to a point.

One constraint shaped everything about how it was drawn. A trade mark spends most of its working life on jackets, polo shirts and van doors, and embroidery is unforgiving: a shape with an internal stroke, a counter or a second colour becomes a thread change, a registration problem and a cost. So the gull is one solid filled path with no stroke at all. Measured from the file, it is a single subpath. It takes one fill, reverses on ink or on Bancha without redrawing, and stitches as a single thread.



The mark

Ink on paper, the default



Reversed

Paper on ink, for dark grounds



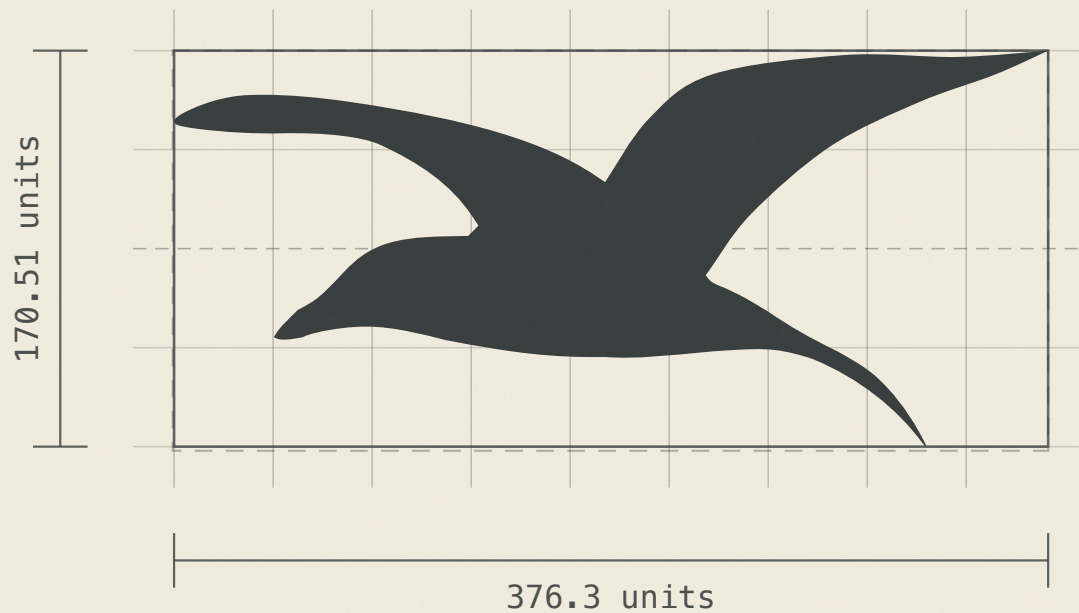
On Bancha

Workwear, site boards and van livery



Horizontal lockup

The gull with BIRDHAM in letter-spaced Spectral and the sub-line beneath



The gull on its 376.9 by 172.3 unit artboard. The drawn ink measures 376.30 by 170.51 units, a ratio of 2.207 to 1, against an artboard ratio of 2.187 to 1. The difference matters in practice: the artwork very nearly fills its box, so there is no built-in clear space and the mark must be given room by whatever places it. Because it is wide and shallow, it is always sized by height and never by width.

ASPECT RATIO

2.21 : 1

Measured from the drawn path

CONSTRUCTION MODULE

42.63 units

A quarter of the drawn height

ARTBOARD

376.9 × 172.3

viewBox units

DRAWN INK

376.30 × 170.51

INK RATIO

2.207 : 1

ARTBOARD RATIO

2.187 : 1

SUBPATHS

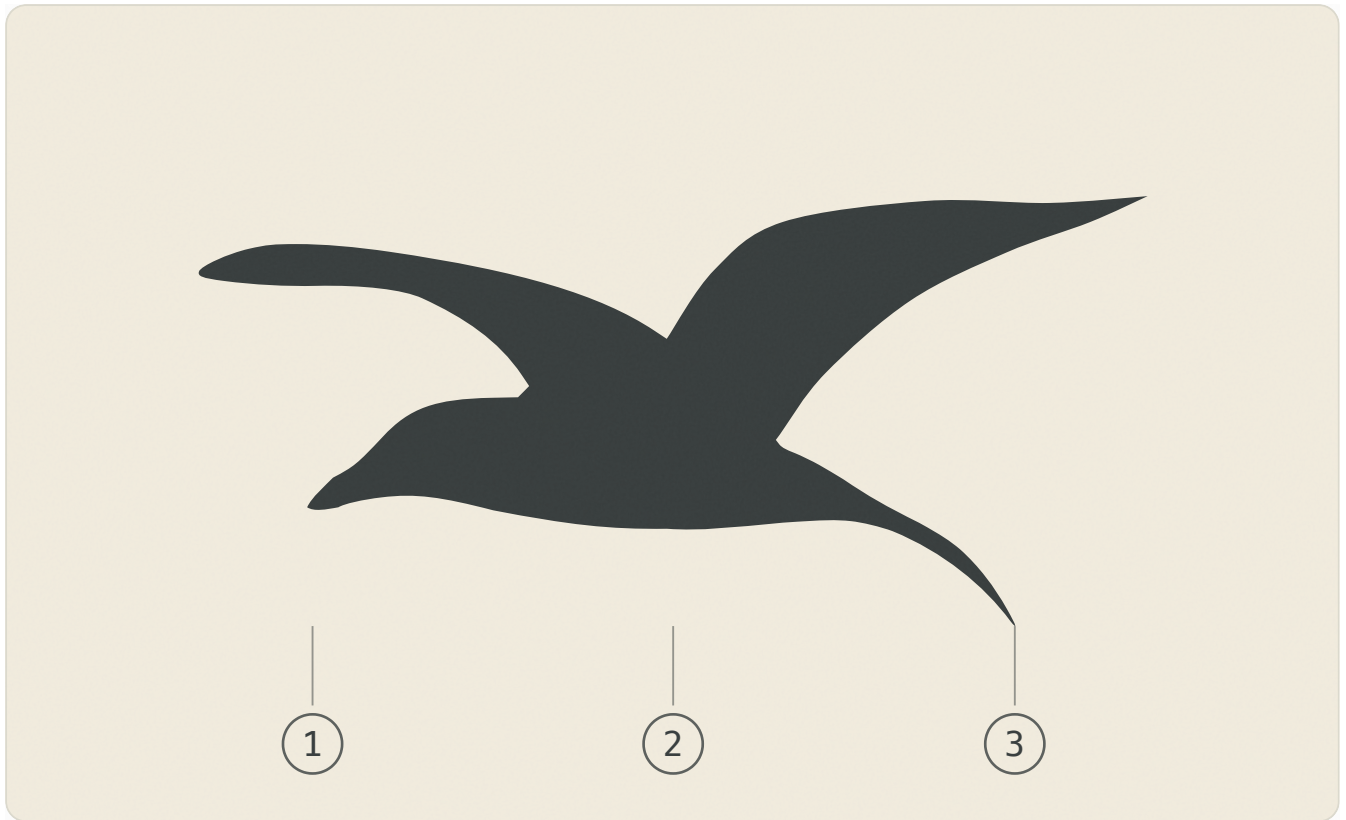
1

One closed shape, single fill

STROKE

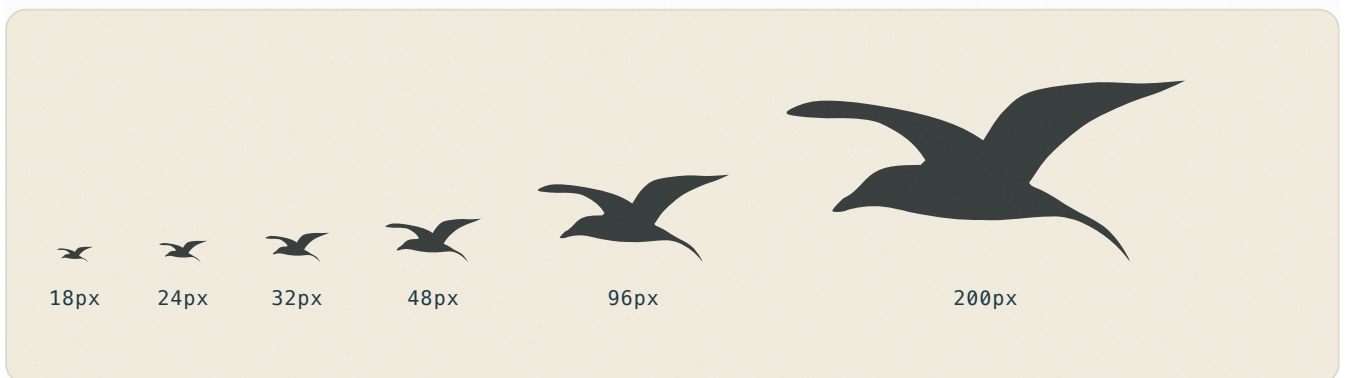
None

An embroidery constraint



The same path is placed at three sizes across the identity, always scaled by a single factor so the drawing is never redrawn for a context.

- 1 **Web header.** Rendered at a 24 pixel height, rising to 28 at desktop. The mark is the only element in the header that is not type.
- 2 **Horizontal lockup.** Placed at 0.255 scale on a 520 by 140 artboard, which puts the gull at 96.1 by 43.9 units with 18 units of margin to the left edge.
- 3 **The seal.** Placed at 0.207 scale inside a double roundel of 60 and 53 unit radii on a 140 unit square, with BIRDHAM arced beneath on a 36 unit radius at 4.5 units of tracking.



The mark tested at working sizes. Because it is a filled silhouette with no internal detail, it survives to the favicon without a simplified cut, which is the practical payoff of the single-path constraint. The website header uses the 24 pixel height, so the second tile is what most visitors actually see.

The lockup sets BIRDHAM in Spectral capitals at a 0.2em letter-space, with Carpentry & building beneath it in Hanken Grotesk at 0.33em. The sub-line's tracking is not a stylistic pick: it is set so that the second line spans exactly the width of the first, which aligns both lines on each edge and

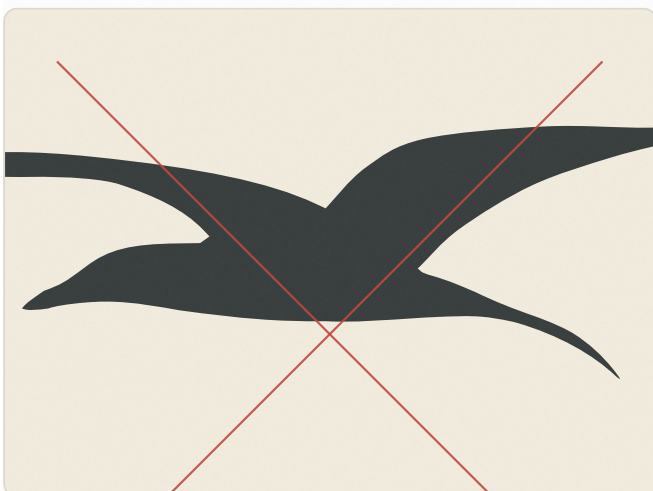
gives the lockup a flush left and right margin. Change the words in the sub-line and the tracking has to be reset.

LOCKUP

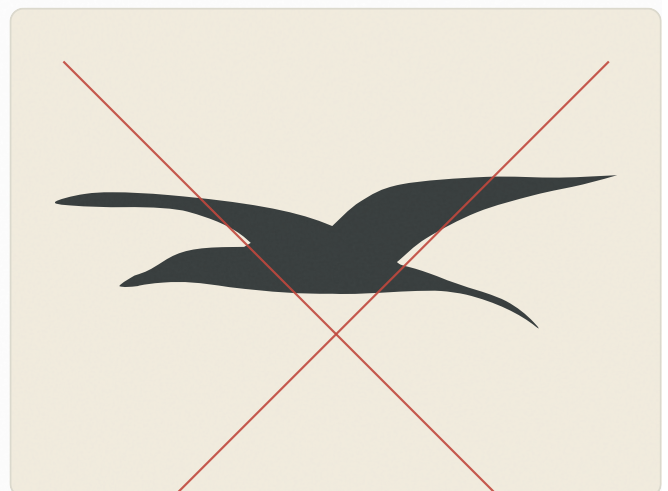
Mark height	24px, 28px at desktop
Wordmark	Spectral 500, uppercase
Wordmark size	1.35rem, 1.5rem at desktop
Wordmark tracking	0.2em
Mark to wordmark gap	14px
Wordmark to sub-line	8px

SUB-LINE AND SEAL

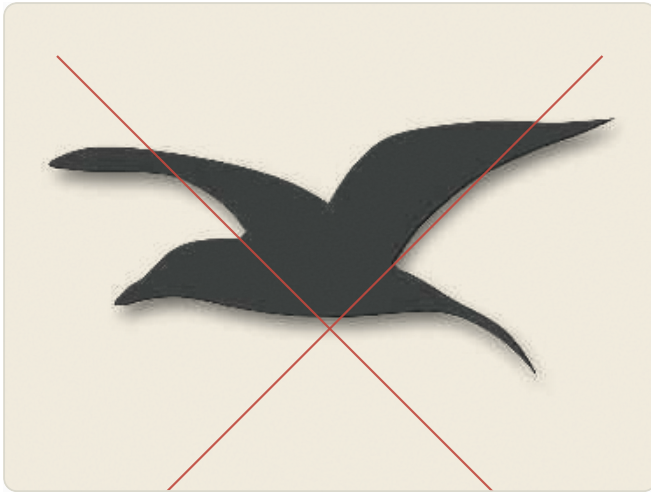
Sub-line	Hanken Grotesk 500, uppercase
Sub-line size	0.5rem, 0.55rem at desktop
Sub-line tracking	0.33em
Seal roundels	r60 at 2, r53 at 1
Seal arc	r36, text 9pt
Seal arc tracking	4.5



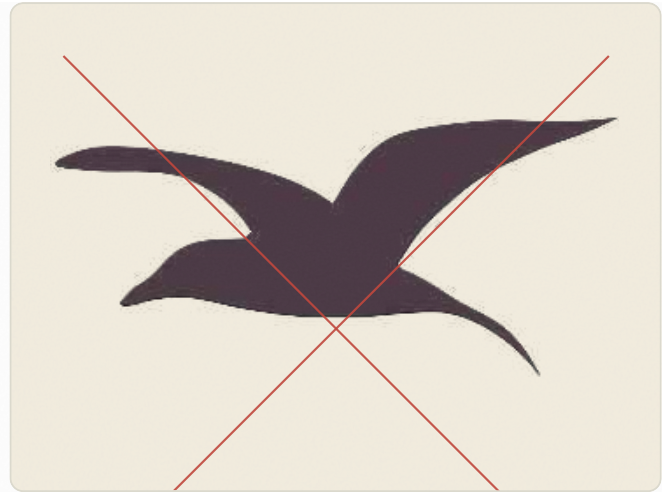
Never scaled on one axis. The mark is sized by height



The 2.207 to 1 ratio is fixed



One flat fill. No shadows, gradients or outlines



Ink, paper or Bancha only



The lockup in service. The sub-line is tracked so that Carpentry & building spans exactly the width of BIRDHAM, which is why both lines align on each edge

Birdham has no written brand manual. These constraints are the ones recorded in the source of the mark itself and enforced by the components that place it, which is why they are stated here as they are implemented rather than dressed up as a rules page that does not exist.

04 Colour

The palette is drawn from heritage paint colours rather than the bright green and gold that trade businesses tend to reach for. The three greens are real Farrow & Ball references, locked on 22 July 2026: Studio Green as the ink, Bancha as the working accent and Card Room Green as the softer secondary. The ground is a warm paper white and never pure white.

The reason is contextual rather than decorative. Most of the firm's work happens against lime render, old brick and weathered oak, and a palette taken from the paints those buildings are actually finished in sits comfortably in a photograph of the finished job.



Ink

#363C3C

54, 60, 60

Type, headers and the mark

Studio Green No.93



Bancha

#676A49

103, 106, 73

The primary brand green

Bancha No.298



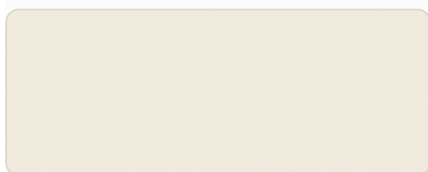
Card Room

#73806E

115, 128, 110

Softer secondary green

Card Room Green No.79

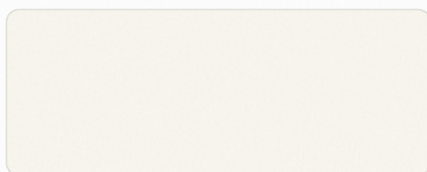


Paper

#F3EDDF

243, 237, 223

Warm ground, never pure white

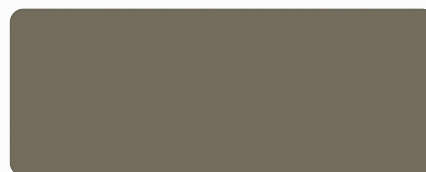


Surface

#FAF7EF

250, 247, 239

Slightly brighter warm surface



Stone

#726A5A

114, 106, 90

Captions and labels

Darkened to meet WCAG AA on paper



Oak

#B98A50

185, 138, 80

Decoration only. Never body text

MEASURED CONTRAST

PAIR	SAMPLE	RATIO	WCAG 2.1
Ink on paper	Sample text	9.6:1	AAA
Stone on paper	Sample text	4.6:1	AA
Bancha on paper	Sample text	4.8:1	AA
Card Room on paper	Sample text	3.6:1	AA large
Oak on paper	Sample text	2.6:1	Fails
Paper on ink	Sample text	9.6:1	AAA
Paper on Bancha	Sample text	4.8:1	AA

Ratios are computed from the hex values on this page under WCAG 2.1, not quoted from the brand document.

The contrast table above is the reason two of these colours carry usage restrictions rather than preferences. Stone was darkened during the build until it cleared the AA threshold on paper, because it sets captions and labels. Oak was left where it is and confined to rules, borders and ornament, because at its measured ratio it cannot carry text at any size. Card Room clears the large-text threshold only, so it is used for headings and panels rather than paragraphs.

05 Typography

The reading face changed during the build. The site opened on Libre Caslon Text and moved to Spectral, and the project README still records the older choice in one line while naming Spectral in another. Spectral sets the wordmark, the headings and the body, which is unusual for a trade site, where the convention is a workhorse sans throughout. A serif reads as considered and slightly old, which is the correct register for a firm whose lead service is listed and period restoration.

Hanken Grotesk handles the working parts: navigation, tracked-caps eyebrows, form labels and the quote flow. The division is functional. If a visitor is reading, it is Spectral. If a visitor is operating something, it is Hanken.

Aa

Spectral

WORDMARK, HEADINGS AND BODY

400, 500, 600

Letter-spaced capitals at 0.2em in the lockup, roman for headings and copy. It replaced Libre Caslon Text partway through the build.

Aa

Hanken Grotesk

INTERFACE AND LABELS

400, 500, 600

Navigation, tracked-caps eyebrows, the sub-line of the lockup and every working part of the quote flow.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789 & £ € , . ; : () " "

Old buildings ask to be repaired the way they were built.

SPECTRAL, THE READING FACE

Wordmark tracking	0.28em
Eyebrow tracking	0.18em
Lockup tracking	0.2em
Sub-line tracking	0.33em
Prose measure	68ch
Soft shadow	0 10px 34px -18px, ink at 35%

06 The site

Four services lead the offer with listed and period restoration in front, and eight area pages cover the catchment from the harbour villages up to the Downs. Each area page is written individually rather than generated from a template with the place name substituted, because thin duplicate location pages are penalised and, more to the point, read as thin.

The centrepiece is the quote flow. A visitor sizes the job, chooses a standard, premium or heritage specification, and receives an indicative range on the spot, in under a minute, without speaking to anyone.

PAGE INVENTORY

Four service pages

Restoration, carpentry and joinery, kitchens, extensions and building

Eight area pages

Chichester, Goodwood, Midhurst, Petworth, Arundel, Bosham, West Wittering, Emsworth

Quote flow

Sized, specified and priced to an indicative range

Shareable quotes

A tokenised link, no login, PDF download and card deposit

Work, about, reviews

The public pages, written in the firm's own voice

Operations admin

Enquiries, clients, quotes, jobs, calendar, invoices, payments



Let's talk about your project

A few details give you an indicative range in a moment, worked out from current material prices at our supplier Covers and typical build rates. It is a guide only. We turn it into a proper quote once we have seen the job.

JOB

DETAILS

REVIEW

What can we help you with?

Choose the closest fit. You can tell us more in a moment.

Restoration

Repair and restoration of listed and period homes.

Carpentry & joinery

Bespoke joinery made in the workshop and fitted by hand.

Kitchens

Handmade kitchens and cabinetry, designed around your room.

Extensions & building

Extensions, renovations and sympathetic building work.

Something else

Not sure which of these fits? Tell us about it and we will help.

We keep deposits modest, between 10 and 15 percent to book your slot, with staged payments on larger jobs. Prefer to talk? Just call and we'll take it from there.

Step one of three. The flow states plainly that the figure is a guide worked out from current material prices, with a firm quote to follow a site visit



BIRDHAM
CARPENTRY & BUILDING

[Restoration](#)[Carpentry & joinery](#)[Kitchens](#)[Building](#)[Our work](#)[About](#)[Contact](#)[REQUEST A QUOTE](#)

Traditional craftsmanship and attention to detail, working with the people and conserving the fabric of the old. We are glad to work alongside conservation officers, architects and heritage consultants, and to give a careful repair the time it needs rather than the time that is quickest.

Project work specified by the customer
range, worked from current Covers
material prices and our build rates.

[REQUEST A QUOTE](#)

What this covers

- Repair and restoration of listed and period homes
- Traditional timber, lime and masonry repair
- Structural timber repair and splicing
- Like-for-like joinery matched to what is there
- Work coordinated with conservation officers and architects
- Sympathetic alterations that respect the original fabric

Related work



Green oak porch, Chichester

The lead service page. Spectral for reading, Hanken for the working parts, and a palette that sits against lime render and old brick



BIRDHAM
CARPENTRY & BUILDING

[Restoration](#)[Carpentry & joinery](#)[Kitchens](#)[Building](#)[Our work](#)[About](#)[Contact](#)[REQUEST A QUOTE](#)

Carpentry, joinery and restoration in Chichester

Our home city and the centre of everything we do.

Birdham Carpentry & Building works throughout Chichester and the wider Chichester area, on the restoration of listed and period homes, fine carpentry and joinery, handmade kitchens and sympathetic building work. We are a local firm, so we know the sort of homes here and the materials that suit them.

A repair to a period property, new joinery, a kitchen: we would be glad to come and look at the job.

[Restoration](#)[Carpentry & joinery](#)[Kitchens](#)[Building](#)[REQUEST A QUOTE IN CHICHESTER](#)

One of eight area pages, each written individually rather than generated from a template with the place name swapped



The same site at 390 pixels

07 The estimating engine

The quote figure is computed rather than guessed. Each service carries a bill of materials expressed as a quantity per unit of size, priced against a maintained supplier list. Labour is added at a rate per unit. A specification multiplier is applied, then a margin, and the result is presented as a band rather than a single number.

The engine always returns a range and never a fixed price, and the interface says so plainly, with a firm quote to follow a site visit. That is a commercial decision as much as a technical one. An online figure presented as final is a figure the firm has to honour or retract, and retracting it is worse than never having given it.

THE CALCULATION

Materials	Bill of materials per unit of size
Material prices	Maintained supplier list
Labour	Rate per unit of size
Margin	18%
Indicative band	±15%

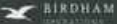
SPECIFICATION MULTIPLIER

Standard	1.00
Premium	1.25
Heritage	1.45
Units	m ² or linear metres
Output	A range, never a fixed price

08 Operations

The public site is the smaller half of the build. Behind the same domain sits a role-gated admin where enquiries convert to clients, quotes convert to jobs, jobs carry stages and calendar bookings, and invoices track payments as they land. The firm runs from it rather than from a spreadsheet and a shoebox.

Quote and invoice PDFs are rendered server-side from the same React components as the on-screen versions. That is the detail that keeps the documents honest: there is no separate PDF template to fall out of step with the site, because there is only one description of what a quote looks like.



[Dashboard](#)

[Enquiries](#)

[Clients](#)

[Quotes](#)

[Jobs](#)

[Calendar](#)

[Invoices](#)

[Payments](#)

[Expenses](#)

[Reports](#)

[Team](#)

[Settings](#)

INV-1000

For Jack Mochally

ALL INVOICES

DESCRIPTION	QTY	UNIT £	VAT	LINE
12345	1	£5,000	0%	£5,000
67890	3	£2,000	0%	£6,000

Payments

No payments recorded yet.

Status

Subtotal

Total

Paid

Balance

Issued 22/07/2026

Due 05/08/2026

Share

VIEW PDF

CLIENT LINK

<https://birdhamcarpentry.co.uk/inv/100100-43>

COPY

Email sending (url) switched on yet. Send this link for now.

Take payment

TAKE CARD PAYMENT

or record manually

Amount (£)

11000.00

Date received

07/22/2026

Type

final

Method

bank transfer

Reference

Birdham Operations: an invoice with its client link, PDF and payment options

PUBLIC

Marketing site

Static. Never reads from the database

Quote flow

Sizes, specifies and prices the job

Tokenised quote link

Opened without a login, served through a security-definer function



OPERATIONS

Admin

Enquiries, clients, quotes, jobs, calendar, invoices

Row-level security

Owner, staff and bookkeeper roles separated

PDF renderer

Quotes and invoices from the same components as the screen



MONEY

Stripe

Deposits and payments

Idempotent webhook

Status accurate through payment, expiry and refund

Deposit

Published as 10 to 15%, defaulting to 12.5%

The public pages never touch the operational database. Everything that reads or writes goes through a server action or a security-definer function.

- Quote links are minted as unguessable tokens, so a client opens a quote without an account and cannot reach anyone else's.
- Deposits are published to clients as 10 to 15 percent of the job. The admin defaults to 12.5, the middle of that band, and it is adjustable on each quote rather than fixed in code, so the firm can hold to what the site promises without a developer.
- The webhook is idempotent, so a Stripe retry cannot double-count a payment or overwrite a refund.

- LocalBusiness, Service, FAQ and breadcrumb structured data are built from confirmed details only, with nothing invented to fill a required field.

WHAT THE HOMEPAGE WEIGHS

Transferred	1.2MB
Requests	33
DOM nodes	306

WHEN IT PAINTS

First contentful paint	156ms
Largest contentful paint	508ms
Load complete	472ms

Measured on 25 August 2026 by loading birdhamcarpentry.co.uk/ twice in headless Chrome at 1440 pixels with the cache disabled, and keeping the better run. This is a desktop connection on a fast line, so the paint figures are a floor rather than a field measurement. The transfer weight and request count are the numbers worth comparing, because they do not change with the connection.

One inconsistency is worth recording. The stone tone appears at two values in the source: the darkened, accessible value used by the site, and an older, lighter value still sitting in the mark's own file. The site ships the darkened one. Anyone picking up the older file for print work should take the value from the site tokens instead.